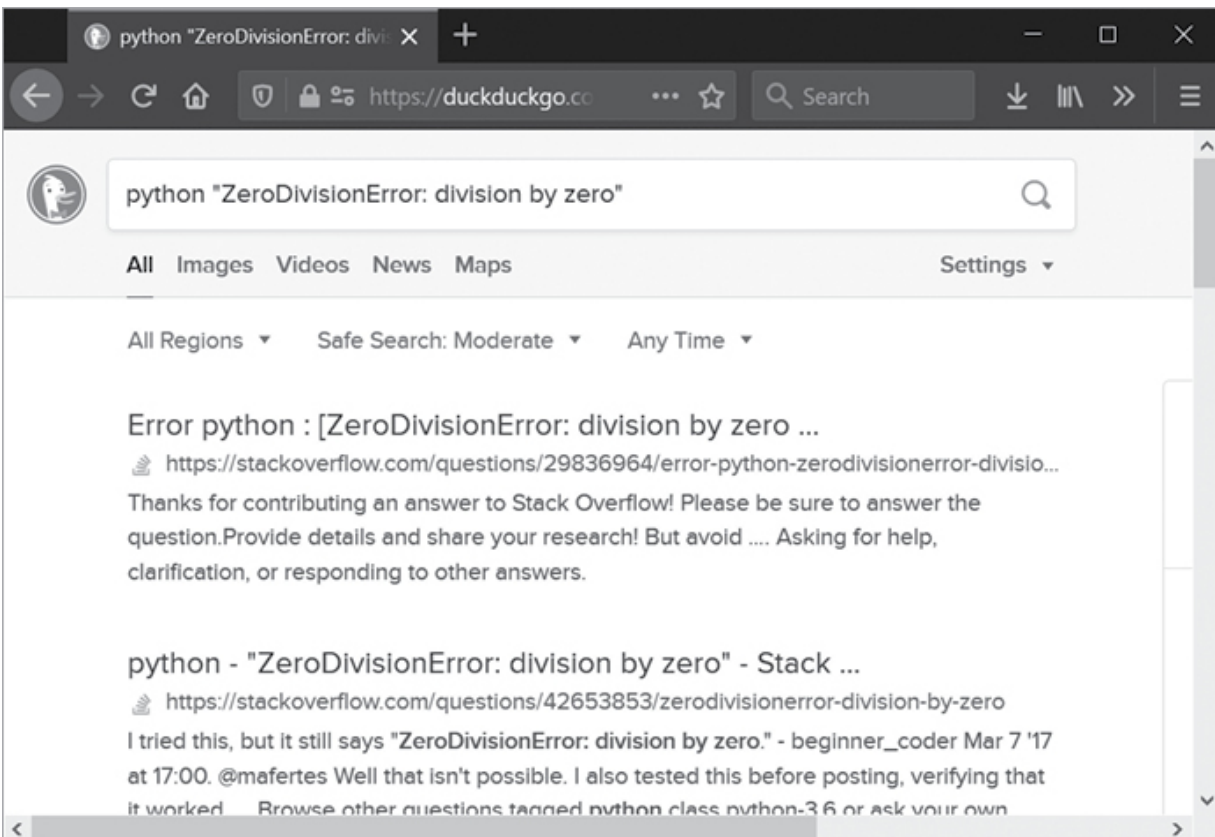


Often, error messages are so short they're not even full sentences. Because programmers encounter them regularly, they're intended as reminders rather than full explanations. If you're encountering an error message for the first time, copying and pasting it into an internet search frequently returns a detailed explanation of what the error means and what its likely causes are. [Figure 1-1](#) shows the results of a search for **python "ZeroDivisionError: division by zero"**. Including quotation marks around the error message helps find the exact phrase, and adding the word *python* can narrow down your search as well.



[Figure 1-1](#): Copying and pasting an error message into an internet search tool can quickly provide explanations and solutions.

Searching for error messages isn't cheating. Nobody can be expected to memorize every possible error message for a programming language. Professional software developers search the internet for programming answers on a daily basis.

You might want to exclude any part of the error message that is particular to your code. For example, consider the following error messages: